



BEFORE

When slave-owning Missouri petitioned for statehood in 1819, the more populous North dominated the House of Representatives. In the Senate, 11 free states to 11 slave states kept the balance.

THE MISSOURI COMPROMISE

Missouri's petition provoked mixed responses. A **debate in the Senate about the future of slavery** saw the first attempt to block admission of a new slave state. To restore calm, Henry Clay of Kentucky arranged a series of measures known as the **Missouri Compromise**. In 1820, Missouri entered the Union as a slave state and Maine as a free one. Slavery was barred from the Louisiana Purchase north of Missouri's southern border.

END OF AN ERA

The departure of James Monroe from the White House in 1825 marked **the passing of the Revolutionary generation**. Virginians and enslavers had held the presidency for 32 of the United States' first 36 years, due to the 3/5 clause that overrepresented Southern whites.

The nature and practice of American politics changed fundamentally in the decades following 1820. The Federal Constitution and state laws originally restricted voting and office-holding to those who met property and residency requirements. By the 1830s, however, most states had rewritten their laws to expand suffrage and office-holding to nearly all white male citizens. Fewer people shared the Founders' ideals of political service by the best educated and wealthy. Politics became a profession, as men sought office, wealth, and status by service to a political party. The Democratic Party, in particular, pioneered a system of party discipline that dispensed jobs at the local, state, and national level.

The Jacksonian age

One man who mastered the new politics of personality and orchestrated campaigns was Andrew Jackson of Tennessee. Voters admired his record as the victor of New Orleans—the last major battle of the War of 1812—and as an Indian fighter. Jackson's rise to wealth and influence from rural poverty made him a symbol of the “age of the common man.” As a contestant in a bitterly contested presidential election in 1824, he narrowly lost to John Quincy